INCIDENT RESPONSE DOCUMENTATION

Practice Task: Unusual Login Activity Detected

Analyst: Nwabueze Benita | Classification: Phishing

1. Incident Overview

A suspicious email was submitted for analysis. The email claimed to be from the Microsoft Security Team, alerting the recipient of unusual login activity and requesting immediate account verification via an embedded link. This report documents the full SOC investigation conducted on the email.

Field	Details
Subject	Unusual Login Activity Detected
Sender	info@libreriacies.es
Claimed Identity	Microsoft Security Team
Recipient	sonyundefinedralph@gmail.com
Embedded URL	https://tinyurl[.]com/ypu5kfts
Verdict	PHISHING - Confirmed

2. Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

The following IOCs were identified during investigation:

IOC Type	Value	Verdict
Sender Email	info@libreriacies.es	Suspicious - unrelated to Microsoft
Sender Domain	libreriacies.es	Misconfigured SPF, no DMARC
Recipient Email	sonyundefinedralph@gmail.com	No known breaches
Embedded URL	https://tinyurl[.]com/ypu5kfts	Terminated for ToS violation
IP Address	217.18.161.43	Clean on VirusTotal
Hostname	mail.libreriacies.es	Associated with sender domain
ASN	AS42220 - Trevenque Sistemas De Informacion S.L.	Spain-based hosting provider

3. Email Address Investigation

3.1 Sender: info@libreriacies.es

The email claims to originate from the Microsoft Security Team. However, the domain is unrelated to Microsoft infrastructure. This domain impersonation is a primary indicator of a phishing attempt.

3.2 Recipient: sonyundefinedralph@gmail.com

The recipient email was investigated using HaveIBeenPwned (haveibeenpwned.com).

- Result: No data breaches found.
- The recipient appears to be a genuine user targeted by this phishing campaign.

4. Sender Domain Analysis

Tool used: MXToolbox (mxtoolbox.com) - MX Lookup and SPF Lookup

Check	Result	Implication
DNS Record	Found	Domain is active and registered
DMARC Record	Not Found	No email authentication policy. Spoofing is possible.
SPF Record	Found but Misconfigured	Contains characters after -all terminator. References unrelated domain serlogal.arnoia.com
VirusTotal	0 Detections	No known malicious history but not conclusive

SuperTool Beta9

libreriacies.es | MX Lookup

mx:libreriacies.es Find Problems | Solve Email Delivery Problems | mx

Microsoft Outlook.com now requires DMARC - Get SPF, DKIM and DMARC setup and maintain compliance with Delivery Center

Pref	Hostname	IP Address	TTL	
10	mail.libreriacies.es	217.18.161.43 TREVENQUE SISTEMAS DE INFORMACION S.L. (AS42220)	5 min	Blacklist Check SMTP Test

	Test	Result	
✗	DMARC Record Published	No DMARC Record found	More Info
✗	DMARC Policy Not Enabled	It is recommended to use a quarantine or reject policy. To enable BIMI, it is required to have one of these at 100%.	More Info
✓	DNS Record Published	DNS Record found	

SPF Record value found:

`v=spf1 +a +mx -all +a:serlogal.arnoia.com`

spf:libreriacies.es Error

Microsoft Outlook.com now requires DMARC - Get SPF, DKIM and DMARC setup and maintain compliance with Delivery Center

```
v=spf1 +a +mx -all +a:serlogal.arnoia.com
```

Prefix	Type	Value	PrefixDesc	Description
	v	spf1		The SPF record version
+	a		Pass	Match if IP has a DNS 'A' record in given domain.
+	mx		Pass	Match if IP is one of the MX hosts for given domain name.
-	all		Fail	Always matches. It goes at the end of your record.
+	a	serlogal.arnoia.com	Pass	Match if IP has a DNS 'A' record in given domain.

Key issues with this SPF record:

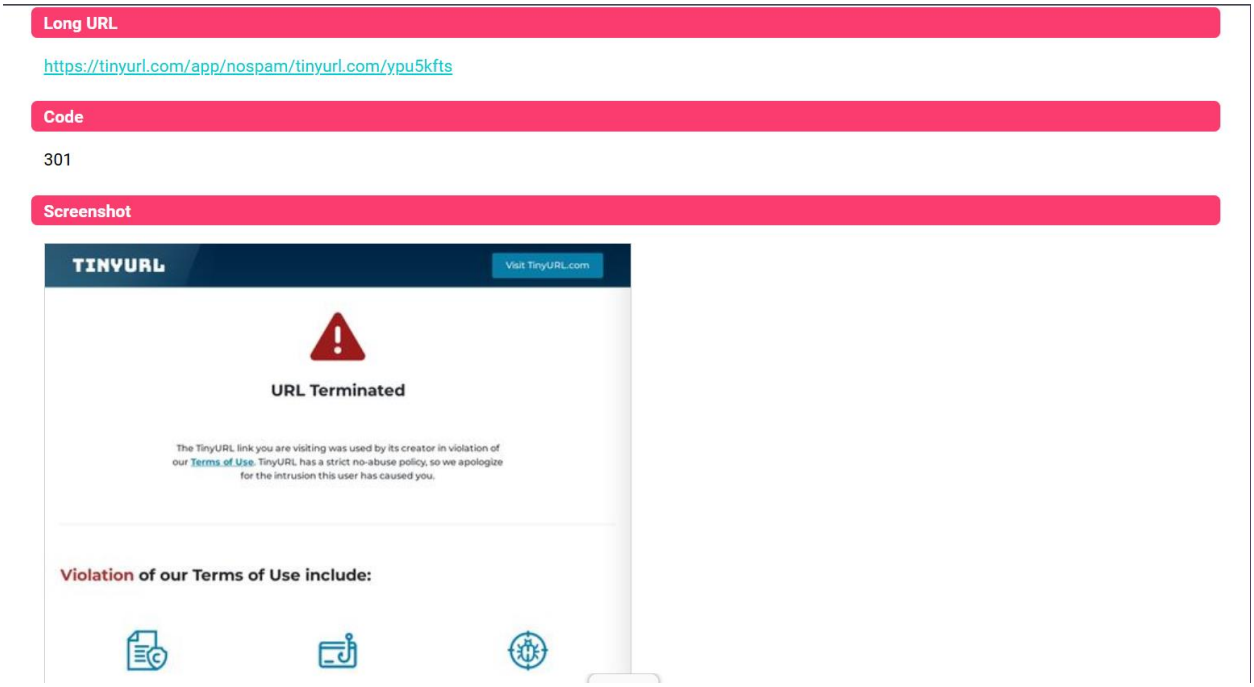
- The -all directive should terminate the record. Any entries after it are ignored by mail servers.
- +a:serlogal.arnoia.com appears after -all, making it invalid and suspicious.
- This level of misconfiguration is inconsistent with a legitimate, professionally managed domain.

5. Embedded URL Analysis

Tool used: CheckShortURL (checkshorturl.com)

URL analyzed: https[:]//tinyurl[.]com/ypu5kfts

Check	Finding
HTTP Response Code	301 - Moved Permanently (active redirect detected)
TinyURL Status	URL Terminated
Reason for Termination	Violation of TinyURL Terms of Use - flagged as abusive
Redirect Technique	Short URL used to conceal true malicious destination



The use of a URL shortener to conceal a redirect destination is a well-documented phishing technique. The fact that TinyURL independently identified and terminated this link for abuse confirms malicious intent.

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6. Social Engineering Techniques Identified

The email employs two classic social engineering tactics:

Technique	Evidence in Email
Urgency / Pressure	"If you do not verify your account within 24 hours, access to your mailbox may be restricted"
Impersonation	Claims to be Microsoft Security Team and IT Support Desk to establish false credibility

7. Conclusion and Verdict

VERDICT: PHISHING INCIDENT CONFIRMED

Based on the cumulative findings of this investigation, this email is a phishing attempt. The following evidence supports this conclusion:

- Sender domain libreriacies.es has no affiliation with Microsoft Corporation.
- No DMARC record found - sender authentication cannot be verified.
- SPF record is misconfigured with entries after the -all terminator and references an unrelated domain.
- Embedded TinyURL was active with a 301 redirect and was subsequently terminated by TinyURL for Terms of Use violation.
- Email employs urgency and authority impersonation - hallmark social engineering techniques.

8. Investigation Tools Used

Tool	URL	Purpose
MXToolbox	mxtoolbox.com	MX Lookup, SPF and DMARC record analysis
VirusTotal	virustotal.com	Domain and IP reputation check
HavelBeenPwned	haveibeenpwned.com	Recipient email breach check
CheckShortURL	checkshorturl.com	Safe URL expansion and redirect analysis